

Word Ladders

Change ONE letter each step — grades 4-6

Name _____

Date _____

Start at the top word. Change **one letter** on each step to make a new real word, until you reach the bottom word.

Ladder 1

G	L	I	D	E
S	H	O	C	K

Ladder 2

S	T	A	R	E
W	H	I	T	E

Ladder 3

S	L	A	C	K
S	P	E	L	L

Ladder 4

S	C	E	N	T
S	H	A	P	E

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Answer Key

Sample answers. Any ladder is correct if every step changes just one letter and makes a real word.

Ladder 1

G	L	I	D	E
S	L	I	D	E
S	L	I	C	E
S	L	I	C	K
S	T	I	C	K
S	T	O	C	K
S	H	O	C	K

Ladder 2

S	T	A	R	E
S	T	O	R	E
S	T	O	N	E
S	H	O	N	E
S	H	I	N	E
W	H	I	N	E
W	H	I	T	E

Ladder 3

S	L	A	C	K
S	T	A	C	K
S	T	A	L	K
S	T	A	L	L
S	M	A	L	L
S	M	E	L	L
S	P	E	L	L

Ladder 4

S	C	E	N	T
S	C	E	N	E
S	C	O	N	E
S	C	O	R	E
S	C	A	R	E
S	H	A	R	E
S	H	A	P	E